Why do we need multiples and submultiples?

Bacterium	Ant	Pencil	Student	Almansa – Albacete	Earth's diameter
2 µm	**3 mm**	**18 cm**	**1.55 m**	**75 km**	**12.7 Mm**

10^{-6} m	10^{-3} m	10^{-2} m	1 m	10^{3} m	10^{6} m
0.000002 m	0.003 m	0.18 m	base unit	75 000 m	12 700 000 m

With a prefix, every measurement is written with a **small, easy number** instead of many zeros.